

**BEFORE THE PUBLIC UTILITIES COMMISSION
OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA**



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Order Instituting Rulemaking Regarding
Microgrids Pursuant to Senate Bill 1339
and Resiliency Strategies.

Rulemaking 19-09-009
(Filed September 12, 2019)

**COMMENTS OF THE VEHICLE-GRID INTEGRATION COUNCIL ON TRACK 1
MICROGRID AND RESILIENCY STRATEGIES STAFF PROPOSAL**

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Dated: January 30, 2020

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In accordance with Rules of Practice and Procedure of the California Public Utilities Commission (“Commission”), the Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (“VGIC”)¹ hereby submits comments on Track 1 Microgrid and Resiliency Strategies Staff Proposal submitted in Rulemaking 19-09-009. Pursuant to *Administrative Law Judge’s Ruling Requesting Comments on Track 1 Microgrid and Resiliency Strategies Staff Proposal*, issued by Administrative Law Judge Colin Rizzo on January 21, 2020, VGIC timely files these comments on January 30, 2020 in R. 19-09-009. VGIC also filed a motion for party status in these proceedings on January 30, 2020.

I. INTRODUCTION

VGIC is a 501(c)6 membership-based advocacy group committed to advancing the role of electric vehicles (“EVs”) and vehicle-grid integration (“VGI”) through policy development, education, outreach, and research. VGIC supports the transition to a decarbonized transportation and electric sector by ensuring the value from EV deployments and flexible EV charging and

¹ The views expressed in these Comments are those of VGIC, and do not necessarily reflect the views of all of the individual VGIC member companies or supporters. (<https://www.vgicouncil.org/>).

discharging is recognized and compensated in support of achieving a more reliable, affordable, and efficient electric grid. VGIC appreciates the opportunity to participate in this proceeding and contribute to the development of a market for microgrids and resiliency solutions.

II. COMMENTS

VGIC commends the considerable effort made by stakeholders that presented proposals in the workshop held on December 12, 2019. In particular, the VGIC would like to thank the Staff for considering proposals that enable VGI solutions for resiliency purposes, such as “Interconnection Proposal 4: Allow the use of smart meters for electrical isolation”².

VGIC believes that solutions like Interconnection Proposal 4 that leverage existing plug-in electric vehicles (“PEVs”) for resiliency functions would represent a significant step forward in establishing a market for products and services that can help mitigate the impact of future power outages. As the Commission weighs next steps, VGIC recommends that special consideration be given to the short-term opportunities to achieve overall resiliency goals through increased provision and intelligent integration of PEVs. Actions can be taken now to facilitate vehicle-to-home (“V2H”) or vehicle-to-load (“V2L”) solutions, which may allow PEVs to provide backup power to islanded loads in the event of a public safety power shutoff (“PSPS”). Some of these actions can be taken in the short-term to enable V2H/V2L implementation (at least for a subset of PEVs), by the September 1, 2020 target date. For example, VGIC recommends that the Commission require each IOU to establish a pilot program with the goal of implementing V2H or V2L backup power solutions in advance of the target date. If successful, these programs can be scaled up in future years. Furthermore, these programs would also serve

² Staff Proposal, 3.1.3-6 p. 10-14

the dual purpose of advancing California’s overall clean energy policy goals (e.g. transportation electrification).

Given the current state of technology, including the capabilities of smart meters and available PEVs, the VGIC believes that overlooking V2H/V2L solutions would not constitute a comprehensive approach to the actions available in the short-term (i.e. before September 2020) for facilitating microgrids and resiliency strategies. Several automotive manufacturers (“OEMs”) and EV supply equipment (“EVSE”) companies, some of which are VGIC members or supporters, have recently indicated the technological readiness of PEVs to provide V2H/V2L functionality either through an on-board inverter (i.e. AC interconnection) or through an external device (i.e. DC interconnection). While there are some existing regulatory barriers to the broader implementation of V2G solutions through an AC approach due to current interconnection rules (i.e. Rule 21) and standards, VGIC believes these solutions could still be pursued now on a limited pilot scale.³ Additionally, there are fewer barriers to V2H/V2L solutions through a DC interconnection approach which could be readily implemented now.

VGIC would like to emphasize that V2H or V2L backup power solutions represent only a subset of VGI applications that could aid the deployment of microgrids and resiliency solutions. As such, VGIC would like to continue discussion on pathways to deploying V2H or V2L backup power solutions more broadly, and beyond the 2020 target date, as well as explore other solutions not specified above.

³ The VGI Working Group (established within R.18-12-006) and the Vehicle to Grid Alternating Current Interconnection Technical Subgroup (in both R.17-07-007 and R.18-12-006) have provided thorough exploration into the ease of implementation of these solutions in the short-term.

III. CONCLUSION

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to submit these comments in response to Track 1 Microgrid and Resiliency Strategies Staff Proposal. We look forward to further collaboration with the Commission and stakeholders on this initiative.

Respectfully submitted,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Edward Burgess", with a stylized, flowing script.

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